

Blindspot

A behavioural-bias intervention tool for traders and everyday decisions · Created by Jaden Machado · Project evidence sheet

VERIFY IT

Live site	useblindspot.github.io (free, no account, works offline)
Source code	github.com/useblindspot/useblindspot.github.io
Built	16 Aug – 3 Sep 2026 (9 dated commits; ongoing)
My role	The idea, the choice of economic theory, the six biases tracked, all assessment questions, the decision to intervene <i>before</i> a decision rather than after, and all written content.
Tools used	Interface code built with AI assistance (Claude), disclosed openly in the repository's PROCESS.md.

WHAT IT DOES

1. Profile	10 realistic scenarios score the user 0–9 on six documented biases. Trading mode: loss aversion, FOMO, overconfidence, recency bias, anchoring, herding. Everyday mode: sunk cost, status quo, overconfidence, social proof, anchoring, present bias.
2. Describe	Before acting, the user writes what they are about to do and why, in plain language.
3. Intervene	The tool reads the wording, highlights language linked to each bias, weights it by the user's profile and shows which blind spots may be active, before the decision is made.

Grounded in behavioural economics: Kahneman & Tversky (prospect theory), Thaler (mental accounting, sunk cost), Cialdini (social proof), Samuelson & Zeckhauser (status quo bias), Shiller (narrative economics), Odean (retail overconfidence).

WHY I BUILT IT

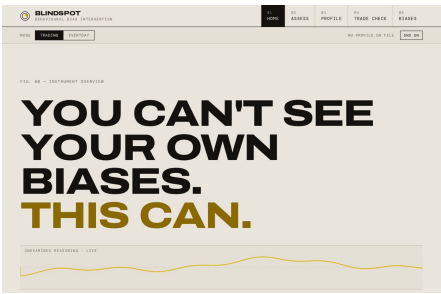
My first trading rule was to buy large companies (at least \$500m market cap) from eToro's daily worst performers when the drop was not caused by anything serious. It worked while I followed it. Then I began taking trades that broke my own criteria, and the losses followed: the rules had not changed, I had. At the same time, a school Economics assignment on nudge theory showed me that small framing effects push decisions without people noticing. The problem was not finding a better strategy; it was knowing, at the moment of a trade, whether I wanted it because of my reasoning or because of a bias.

TESTING, FEEDBACK AND A FLAW I FOUND

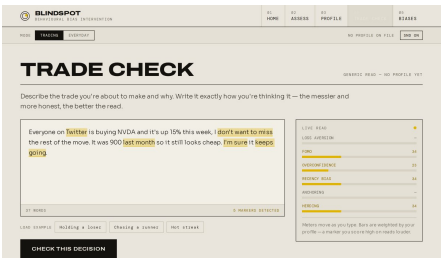
Users can opt in to share anonymous scores (off by default; nothing they type is ever sent). Analysing the first responses, I found a flaw in my own scoring: biases covered by fewer questions produce coarser scores that cluster at the extremes (anchoring came out 9, 9 and 8, while sunk cost came out 0, 0 and 3). So cross-bias comparisons for one person are not yet meaningful. I documented this publicly rather than quietly fixing it.

Responses	30 assessment responses from family friends and Reddit users.
Updates since launch	Added a bias reference screen, moved the data-consent request to after results, and added disclosure of page-load counting (dated commits, 26 Aug – 3 Sep 2026).
Limits I state openly:	it is not a validated psychometric test and makes no claim to improve returns. Validating it would need comparison with an established instrument, stability testing and a control group.

SCREENSHOTS



Home screen



Trade Check reading a sample decision: flagged phrases and live bias meters